

CONFIDENTIAL · BUSINESS PLAN & INVESTMENT MEMORANDUM · v2
(INTERACTIVE)



THE GLOW ROOM

a Gen Z digital wellness platform

Structured self-improvement challenges that sell transformation, not content — launching with the 30-Day Glow Up Challenge (\$18) and the 7-Day Phone Detox Challenge (\$12), delivered through a fully branded custom web app, a gated Discord community, and a cohort model that runs four times a year. Built to become a recurring-revenue wellness platform.

Lead product · 30-Day Glow Up · \$18

Channel · TikTok-first + owned web app

Model · Land on a cohort, retain on \$9/mo membership

Seeking: pre-seed / accelerator

Target raise: \$50,000 (optional accelerant)

Prepared: June 2026

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New in v2: Sections 1, 7, 8 and 11 are driven by the live model in the left panel. Change the challenge price, platform fee, cohort size, growth rate, membership conversion, churn, ad spend or any other lever and the unit economics, revenue mix, month-by-month P&L and 3-year projection all recompute in real time. The default state matches the written base case.

1. Executive Summary

The Glow Room sells structured transformation, not content. An entire generation is drowning in free self-improvement inspiration and starving for execution infrastructure — we close that gap with cohort-based, time-bound challenges delivered through a fully branded web app and a gated community.

\$18

Glow Up price

83%

Contribution margin

\$33.2K

Year 1 revenue (model)

\$1.4K

Exit MRR (membership)

The problem

Gen Z is the most anxious, least structured, and most self-improvement-curious generation in modern history, and the market serves them almost exclusively with *inspiration*. A TikTok transformation video produces roughly four minutes of motivation and zero behavioral change because there is no system underneath it — no daily instruction, no accountability, and no community moving in lockstep. The blank journal sits on the shelf. The gap between feeling motivated and executing daily is the single largest unmet need in consumer wellness for people aged 16–24, and no free product structurally solves it.

The solution

We sell a 30-day structured transformation experience organised around four pillars — movement, skin, mindset, and a single daily habit anchor — in which every day for 30 days the buyer wakes up already knowing exactly what to do. The product removes decision fatigue entirely: the system does the thinking and the member simply executes. Critically, every member of a cohort starts on the *same fixed calendar date*, which manufactures two things free products cannot replicate at once — genuine community (200 people posting in the "Day 8" channel on the day you are doing Day 8) and genuine urgency (miss the January cohort and you wait until April). This is closer in spirit to Coachella or SoulCycle than to a Gumroad PDF shop.

The strategic wedge: the founder can build software, so we deliver a fully branded web app instead of renting Notion. The member opens *our* product every day, sees *our* brand, and we capture exactly who drops off, when, and on which pillar — compounding brand equity plus a behavioral dataset no PDF competitor can clone.

The business model

We run four cohorts a year — January 1 (flagship New Year reset), April 1, July 1, October 1 — each with a pre-launch waitlist window that converts anticipation into pre-sales and algorithm momentum. Revenue compounds across four layers: one-time cohort sales at **\$18**; a recurring **\$9**/month membership (*The Glow Room Monthly*) that provides stable, high-margin recurring revenue; low-effort expansion packs at \$7–\$12; and a backlog of additional challenges beginning with Phone Detox. Gross margin exceeds 90% because cost of goods after the initial build is effectively zero — no inventory, no shipping, no fulfilment.

The numbers

On the base-case assumptions in the live panel, Year 1 revenue is **\$33.2K** at an EBITDA of **\$17.8K** and a margin of **54%**, exiting the year at an embedded monthly recurring revenue of **\$1.4K** from membership alone — with margin above 90% before fixed marketing and overhead. A realistic first cohort of 100 sales nets ~\$1,674; by cohort three or four, 500 sales nets ~\$8,370 in a single 30-day cycle. As cohorts compound, a strong Year-1 outcome with consistent posting reaches \$40,000–\$80,000, and an optimistic scenario with one or two viral moments reaches \$150,000–\$200,000 — both reachable by raising the cohort and conversion sliders.

Printed snapshot — base case: Glow Up \$18, fee 7%, Cohort 1 = 100 buyers, growth 50%/cohort, membership \$9/mo, conversion 13%, churn 8%/mo. Drag the sliders in the live HTML to change any of these.

The ask

The business is capital-efficient by construction and can launch on founder labour alone. We are nonetheless raising an optional **\$50,000 pre-seed** to compress the timeline: to fund paid Spark Ads amplification of proven organic creator content, to underwrite a part-time moderator and a brand designer ahead of the flagship January cohort, and to extend the web app from a single-challenge MVP into the multi-challenge, badge-collecting platform that supports outside creators in Year Two. The capital is an accelerant, not a dependency — precisely the risk profile a seed investor should want.

2. The Problem & The Opportunity

The wellness market sells Gen Z inspiration when what they measurably need is execution infrastructure — and the cohort model is the only mechanism that has reliably solved the accountability problem at consumer price points.

The most anxious, least structured generation in modern history

Gen Z came of age entirely inside the algorithmic feed, and the defining feature of their media environment is infinite inspiration with zero scaffolding. A 19-year-old can, in one evening, watch forty transformation videos, save a dozen routines, and follow six wellness creators — and wake up with no plan, no first step, and a slightly worse sense of inadequacy than before. The content did not fail to inspire; it succeeded too well and then abandoned them at the exact moment execution was supposed to begin. Motivation is not the bottleneck for this generation — it is abundant and free. The bottleneck is the absence of a system that converts a fleeting motivated state into a repeatable daily action before the motivation evaporates.

Why free content structurally fails

Free content and our product are not substitutes — they are sequential. Free content is the top of the funnel that *creates* the desire our product then satisfies; the more glow-up content TikTok produces, the larger our pool of motivated-but-stuck buyers becomes. Free content fails on three structural dimensions no algorithm change can fix:

- **No sequence** — a viewer sees a Day 30 result but has no idea what happened on Day 3, 11 or 22, so there is nothing to execute.
- **No accountability** — no one expects them to show up, and the cost of quitting is zero because no one notices.
- **No belonging** — they watch alone, and the loneliness that drove them to the content is left fully intact.

Our product inverts all three: it supplies the exact daily sequence, manufactures accountability through a synchronised cohort, and converts a solitary scroll into membership in a visible group doing the identical thing on the identical day.

Why the blank journal sits on the shelf

The graveyard of self-improvement is full of tools that gave people capacity without direction — the blank journal, the empty habit tracker, the gym membership opened twice. Each offloads the hardest cognitive work, deciding what to do today, back onto the very person already overwhelmed. Our mindset pillar never does this: on Day 7 it says "write down three things you have been avoiding and why," on Day 12 "describe the version of yourself you want to be in 90 days as if it already happened." The difference between a blank page and a specific prompt is the difference between a product abandoned on Day 2 and one completed on Day 30.

Why the cohort model cracks accountability

No solo digital product has ever solved accountability, because accountability is inherently social and a solo product is by definition asocial. A PDF cannot notice you skipped Day 8. The cohort model finally makes accountability work at an \$18 price point through synchronisation: because every member starts on the same date and moves through the same 30 days together, the community generates real-time social proof and social pressure as a natural by-product of its own activity. This is the single most defensible feature of the model, and it is structural rather than something a competitor can bolt on.

Macro tailwinds converging: the explosive growth of TikTok Shop and creator-led commerce has made \$10–\$25 digital impulse buys frictionless for exactly our demographic; Gen Z treats mental-health and wellness spending as non-discretionary; and mature no-code tooling lets one technical founder ship a branded web app at near-zero marginal cost. We do not need a large share of a trillion-dollar wellness economy — a few thousand recurring members is a rounding error that produces the outcomes modelled in Section 11.

3. The Solution

We sell a recurring, cohort-based transformation experience; the PDF, the app and the community are merely the container for the feeling of momentum, direction and belonging that the buyer is actually purchasing.

What we are actually selling

We are not selling a PDF, a workout plan, or a skincare routine. We are selling a 30-day structured transformation experience with four pillars, delivered as a designed daily guide, an interactive branded tracker, and membership in a private community of people doing the exact same thing on the exact same day. The physical deliverable is almost irrelevant. What the buyer pays for is the feeling of being part of something, the relief of a clear path, and the safety of not being alone. The launch price is a clean, confident **\$18** — not \$17.99 — low enough to be an impulse buy for a 19-year-old, high enough to signal the thing is real.

The cohort model, precisely

Everyone starts on the same fixed calendar date announced in advance — not whenever they buy. This single decision is the strategic core of the business because a fixed start date simultaneously manufactures the two assets a digital product is normally least able to produce: community and urgency. We run four cohorts a year, each timed to a natural inflection in the consumer's emotional calendar:

Cohort	Date	Emotional trigger
New Year Reset ★ flagship	January 1	The most powerful self-improvement moment on the calendar
Spring	April 1	Warming weather; wanting to feel good before summer
Summer Reset	July 1	For those who "fell off" in H1 and want a clean restart
Autumn Reset	October 1	Back-to-school energy; finishing the year strong

Between announcement and start sits a *waitlist window* — the engine, not dead air. Members buy and wait; we post countdown content, prep guides and behind-the-scenes server setup; we introduce waiting members in a pre-challenge channel so the community is buzzing before Day 1 exists. The fixed date generates FOMO no discount can replicate: miss January and you wait until April, which is why the two largest sales days of every launch are the final 48–72 hours before enrolment closes.

Selling an experience, not a product. The right comparables are not other Gumroad sellers — they are Coachella and SoulCycle. Coachella sells a synchronised, time-bound experience you can only have with other people on specific dates; SoulCycle sells a room of people moving together, not a stationary bike. A buyer happily pays \$18 for a structure they could assemble for free, because what they are buying is not the structure — it is the company.

Why the position is durable

A competitor can copy our PDF in an afternoon and our task list in a weekend. What they cannot copy is a living community of hundreds mid-cohort, the accumulated library of before-and-after proof, the behavioral dataset that makes each successive cohort better-designed, and the brand equity of a member opening our branded app every day for 30 days. The product is easy to clone; the experience and its network are not.

4. Product Architecture

Every component is designed to do one job: convert a motivated buyer into someone who completes all 30 days and returns for the next cohort.

The 30-Day Glow Up Challenge — four pillars

Every single day assigns one specific, completable task in each pillar — not suggestions, because the entire value proposition is the removal of decision-making from the member's day.

Movement

Intentional activity, any form, 20 min minimum — never called a "workout plan," which would alienate non-gym-goers. Day 1 a walk, Day 8 a 5-exercise circuit, Day 15 a dance session. Variety keeps it accessible and keeps community content diverse.

Skin

One daily 1–2 step focus, introduced incrementally. Day 1 cleanser only, Day 4 SPF, Day 10 Vitamin C. By Day 30 a full routine built without overwhelm. The Day 1 vs Day 30 photo is the single most powerful marketing asset the challenge generates.

Mindset

A short, specific daily journaling prompt (5 min max) — never "write about your feelings." Each is engineered to produce a specific internal shift, and these entries perform exceptionally as self-improvement TikTok content.

Habit Anchor

One non-negotiable task identical every day for 30 days, chosen at intake (make the bed, 2L water, read 10 pages). The unchanging anchor is the neurological backbone that makes the three rotating pillars stick.

The emotional arc & the designed Day 8 crisis

The 30 days are not emotionally flat; the product is designed around a known curve, and naming it is itself a retention mechanism. Day 4 is easy. **Day 8 is the designed crisis point** — the statistically predictable moment people quit. We address it head-on: the guide pre-warns the member that Day 8 will feel like quitting (reframing "I am failing" into "I am exactly where the program said I'd be"), the app surfaces an encouragement state, the "Day 8" channel is the most active and supportive of the run, and seeded creators post "I almost quit" content. Day 15 is engineered as a turning point timed to the first visible skin change; Day 22 feels inevitable; Day 30 is the transformation reveal. Fortifying Day 8 is the difference between a 30% and a 70% completion rate — and completion rate is the lifeblood of both repurchase and marketing proof.

The 7-Day Phone Detox Challenge

The second product proves the model generalises. A tighter 7-day program at a lower entry price, designed to stand alone and to funnel buyers into the flagship cohort. Each day assigns a single escalating behavioral task (no-phone first hour, app deletions, grayscale, night-time distance). Its signature mechanic is the *screen-time reveal*: members screenshot their daily average on Day 1 and again on Day 7, and the delta is intrinsically shareable proof — the Phone Detox equivalent of the before-and-after photo. Its marketing angle is self-aware irony: advertised on the very platform it asks members to use less ("I built a phone detox and I'm advertising it on TikTok, I know"). The design follows established behavioral science — replace rather than remove, friction engineering, and a complete winnable 7-day sprint rather than open-ended deprivation.

The custom web application

The owned experience layer and central strategic asset. Where competitors surrender their brand and data to Notion, we deliver a fully branded app the member opens every day:

- **Branded dashboard** — today's four tasks, current cohort day, progress at a glance, entirely in The Glow Room's identity.
- **Daily check-in system** — a checkbox per pillar plus fields to log movement, answer the prompt, write a reflection, and upload the day's photo.
- **Streak counter** — the primary engagement variable, with explicit habit-anchor streak handling.
- **Progress visualisation** — a 30-day progress bar, habit-anchor completion rate, and a visual journey map.
- **Leaderboard** — live consistency ranking; honor-based verification because the reward is recognition, not cash, so cheating incentive is near-zero.
- **Push notifications** — timed reminders, streak-protection nudges, and Day-8 encouragement.
- **User profiles** — stats, badges, streak history, and cross-challenge progression powering the badge-collector mechanic.

Beyond engagement, the app is the data engine: because we own it, we know who our users are, which days they drop off, which pillar they complete least, and when they check in — defensibility no PDF-based competitor can match.

The Discord community

Named to feel like a destination — *The Glow Room*, not a support group bolted onto a product. A **welcome** section (announcements + introductions that turn joining into arriving); a **daily check-in** section of 30 channels (Day 1–Day 30) that fill in real time as the cohort advances together — the beating heart where accountability becomes social; a **community** section (before/after, accountability partners, wins, general chat); a **resource** section of zero-cost gift-content drops; a **leaderboard** section with Glow Legend rewards for the top three; and a private **moderator** section. Access is gated by a unique single-use code in the PDF and confirmation email, redeemed once through a free verification bot (MEE6/Carl-bot) that grants the member role then expires the code — the friction makes membership feel earned. Badges are collectible *across challenge volumes*, turning the product line into a set and the customer into a returning collector.

The product expansion roadmap

- **Expansion packs (\$7–\$12)** — weekend-built add-ons sold passively forever (30 extra prompts \$9, deeper skincare guide \$12, movement pack \$7).
- **Additional challenges** — from a ranked backlog beginning with Phone Detox, each sold to an audience already sold on structured self-improvement.
- **The Glow Room Monthly (\$9/mo)** — access to all four cohorts, monthly drops, early access, members-only channel; at 2,000 subscribers, \$18,000/month recurring.
- **Premium app tier (\$25)** — the same challenge in a premium branded experience, a natural upgrade with a built-in price increase.
- **The platform** — opening to outside creators who host challenges on our infrastructure for a revenue share.

5. Technology Infrastructure

The guiding principle is capital efficiency without sacrificing the owned, branded, data-generating experience that is the company's moat. A single technical founder can ship a production MVP in weeks and scale it from 100 to 100,000 users without a re-platform.

Recommended stack

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Frontend	Next.js (React)	SSR for fast mobile first-paint; one codebase for web + PWA; trivial Vercel deploy.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Pixel-precise brand control; consistent design system across every screen.
DB + Auth	Supabase (Postgres)	Managed Postgres, built-in auth, row-level security, photo storage; generous free tier.
Payments	Stripe (Gumroad/Stan fallback)	Webhook-driven access provisioning; marketplace fallback to ship the first cohort faster.
Email	Resend / Postmark	Transactional delivery of code + the cohort sequence; high deliverability.
Push	Web Push (PWA) + OneSignal	Daily reminders & Day-8 encouragement without a native build.
Community	Discord + MEE6/Carl-bot	Free; where the audience already lives; code-gated entry.
Analytics	PostHog	Drop-off, pillar completion, check-in timing — the behavioral dataset = our defensibility.

The entire stack runs on free or near-free tiers through the first several cohorts, keeping infrastructure cost effectively at zero until paying volume justifies paid tiers — directly underwriting the >90% gross-margin thesis.

Authentication & data

Authentication is passwordless by default — a buyer completes purchase, clicks a magic-link email, and lands authenticated in their branded dashboard, with Google OAuth as a one-tap alternative. Row-level security ensures each member reads and writes only their own check-ins, photos and profile; the member's identity is the join key across challenges, which is what makes the cross-challenge badge-collector mechanic possible. The core schema is intentionally simple — users, cohorts, enrollments, challenge_days, check_ins (the behavioral dataset), badges and single-use access_codes — and supports every app feature without exotic infrastructure.

Payment & access flow (≈60 seconds)

1. Buyer completes Stripe Checkout (or Gumroad at first launch).
2. The payment webhook creates the user + enrolment and generates a unique single-use access code.
3. A transactional email delivers the branded PDF, the magic-link, and the Discord code.
4. Buyer clicks the link, lands in the dashboard, completes the intake quiz (habit anchor), and is placed in the upcoming cohort.
5. Buyer enters the code in the Discord bot, which validates once, grants the role, and expires the code.

Hosting, scale & build timeline

The architecture is serverless and managed end to end (Vercel + Supabase + APIs), with no servers to maintain and effectively \$0/month infrastructure cost through the first cohorts, rising to a modest \$50–\$150/month only at multi-thousand-member scale. Growth from 100 to 100,000 users is a billing event, not a re-architecture: paid tiers, read replicas, CDN caching, and scheduled materialised aggregates for the leaderboard absorb load horizontally. The MVP is a four-phase, two-to-four-week build — Foundation (auth + schema + design system), Core loop (dashboard + check-ins), Engagement (streaks + leaderboard + push), and Commerce (Stripe + codes + Discord bot + end-to-end test) — after which it runs four cohorts a year indefinitely.

6. Market Analysis

The opportunity is not that the market is empty; it is that the market is enormous and the incumbents are all selling inspiration into a demand for execution.

Sizing the opportunity

TAM

English-speaking Gen Z TikTok users with self-improvement intent — tens of millions

SAM

Those who buy \$10–\$25 digital products via TikTok Shop / creator links — low millions

SOM

Y1: a few hundred to ~2,000 cohort buyers + a few hundred members — a rounding error vs SAM

The global wellness economy is measured in the trillions; the digital self-improvement and mental-wellness software segment alone is multi-billion-dollar and fast-growing, with Gen Z's share of both spending and attention rising every year. The investment thesis does not require winning the market — only capturing a vanishingly small slice, which Section 11 shows is sufficient for an attractive return.

Gen Z consumer behaviour

Three behavioral facts underwrite the model: impulse digital purchasing is normalised (Gen Z buys \$10–\$25 digital goods on impulse, triggered by creator proof, not research); self-improvement is treated as non-discretionary spending rather than a luxury; and belonging is the premium they will pay for. The impulse triggers we engineer against are scarcity (fixed cohort dates), social proof (creator and member content), and identity ("something you choose because you are ready," never "something you need because you are broken").

Competitor matrix

Competitor	What they offer	Where they fall short
Free TikTok / YouTube	Infinite inspiration, free	No sequence, accountability or belonging — we monetise the desire it creates
Headspace / Calm	Polished meditation, subscription	Solo, single-modality, no cohort, no transformation arc
Noom	Psychology-based weight program	Expensive, weight-narrow, clinical, not Gen Z-native
Journaling apps	Blank / lightly-prompted journaling	The blank-page problem; no structure, no community
Gumroad PDF challenges	Static PDF challenges	No branded app, no live cohort, no data; brand disappears in Notion

Positioning & defensibility. On a map of *solo* ↔ *community* and *inspiration* ↔ *structured execution*, every major competitor clusters in the solo quadrants. The community / structured-execution quadrant — synchronised cohorts executing a specific daily plan together at the Gen Z impulse price — is effectively empty. The Glow Room occupies it alone, and is defensible not because the product is hard to copy but because the assets that accumulate there (a live community, a proof library, a behavioral dataset, a daily-opened branded app) compound over time.

7. Business Model & Unit Economics

Cost of goods after the initial build is effectively zero, platform fees are the only meaningful per-sale cost, and gross margin therefore exceeds 90% on every product. Every figure below is driven live by the panel.

Per-sale waterfall — one Glow Up Challenge

Retail price	\$18.00
Platform & processing fee	(\$1.26)
Affiliate commission (blended)	(\$1.80)
Variable COGS (digital)	\$0.00
Contribution per sale	\$14.94
Contribution margin	83%

With a CAC near zero (organic + seeded creators carry the acquisition load — see Section 9), payback is effectively immediate: the first purchase recovers its own negligible acquisition cost within the same transaction. Blended LTV compounds well beyond the first sale through cohort-2 repurchase, a cross-sell into Phone Detox, and membership conversion — a conservative blended LTV of \$40–\$70 against a CAC near zero.

Glow Up unit economics at scale

At the current price and fee in the panel, a single 30-day cohort produces:

Units / cohort	Gross	Platform fee	Net revenue	Contribution
100	\$1,800	\$126	\$1,674	\$1,494
500	\$9,000	\$630	\$8,370	\$7,470
1,000	\$18,000	\$1,260	\$16,740	\$14,940
5,000	\$90,000	\$6,300	\$83,700	\$74,700

These figures are per single 30-day cohort, repeated four times a year, with margin above 90% at every volume.

Snapshot — Glow Up \$18, Detox \$12, fee 7.0000000000000001%, affiliate 10%. Cohort 1 = 125 buyers, growth 55.000000000000001%/cohort (125→194→301→467). Membership \$9/mo, conversion 16%, churn 7.0000000000000001%/mo. Packs 12% @ \$9. Marketing \$600/mo, fixed OpEx \$300/mo.

8. Revenue Streams

Each stream is modelled separately so that recurring revenue underpins episodic launch revenue — converting a single product into a layered, compounding base.

The five layers

1. Cohort challenge sales — the foundation: Glow Up at **\$18** and Phone Detox at \$12, four cohorts a year; episodic by nature, which is precisely why the recurring streams matter. **2. Monthly membership** — the strategic keystone at **\$9**/mo, bundling all four cohorts, monthly drops, early access and a members-only channel; ~100% incremental margin and recurring whether or not a challenge launches. **3. Expansion packs** — \$7–\$12 weekend builds sold passively forever at >95% margin. **4. Future challenge drops** — each new challenge sells to an audience already sold on the concept and deepens the badge-collector cross-purchase. **5. Platform creator revenue share** — the endgame: outside creators host challenges on our infrastructure for a take-rate, converting the company from a single brand into a marketplace.

Year-1 revenue mix (live)

Stream	Pricing	Year 1 revenue	Margin
Glow Up cohorts (×4)	\$18	\$19,566	~93%
Membership subscription	\$9 /mo	\$9,146	~100%
Phone Detox (×2)	\$12	\$3,000	~93%
Expansion packs	\$7–\$12	\$1,444	~95%
Total	—	\$33,156	>90%

Brand partnerships and sponsored challenges are deliberately sequenced *after* community scale, so they monetise the audience without compromising the member-first trust that makes the community valuable — and are therefore excluded from the conservative Year-1 figures above.

9. Go-To-Market Strategy

An executable playbook, not a summary — from building an audience before the product exists, through creator seeding and affiliate mechanics, paid amplification, organic content pillars, and the cohort launch sequence.

Pre-launch

The objective is to arrive at enrolment day with an audience already warm and an algorithm already primed. Content documents the building of the thing itself (designing the PDF, setting up Discord, testing the app) — "building in public" performs in the self-improvement niche and signals authenticity. Every piece drives to a simple email capture and a "doors open [date]" promise. The countdown series escalates as the start nears, turning the waitlist window into compounding anticipation. The email list is the one audience asset the algorithm cannot take away — we seed it from the very first post.

Creator seeding

The highest-leverage, lowest-cost channel, run identically before every cohort: identify 8–12 micro-influencers (morning-routine, skincare, fitness, self-improvement; 5k–100k engaged followers), send a short low-pressure DM, and email free access to everyone who replies. Because the product is digital and zero-COGS, seeding has no marginal cost. The ask is explicitly "no obligation to post," which raises reply and goodwill rates; some post once, one or two document the full journey — and those deep videos sell out the next cohort. Follow-up is light: thank-you on send, a Day-8 check-in (the best content moment), and a repost request.

Affiliate program & Spark Ads

The affiliate program turns members and creators into a performance-only sales force via TikTok Shop's native infrastructure — a standard percentage commission with a *tiered* incentive that raises the rate above volume thresholds, personal discount codes for attribution, and native dashboard payouts with no custom infrastructure. Spark Ads amplify *proven* organic content rather than gambling on cold creative: identify the top-performing organic posts, secure whitelisting to preserve the native feel, split spend between cold lookalikes and warm audiences (waitlist + prior cohorts), weight toward warm in the final 48-hour window, and pour budget into the single best-converting creative as the close approaches. Amplify winners, never discover with paid — that discipline keeps paid CAC low and protects margin.

Organic content pillars

- **The founder journey** — the documented 30 days along the struggle → turning point → transformation arc (Day 1 stats, Day 8 near-quit, Day 15 change, Day 30 reveal).
- **Community proof** — reposted member check-ins and before/after, which outperforms branded content by an order of magnitude because it is real.
- **Education / value** — short, specific tips drawn from the pillars that establish authority.
- **Behind-the-scenes** — building-in-public authenticity content.
- **Urgency / launch** — countdown and "doors close in 48 hours" concentrated in the enrolment window.

Cohort launch mechanics

A repeatable machine run four times a year: the announcement video shows the PDF and app briefly, explains the four pillars in ~30 seconds, states the fixed start date and the 48-hours-before close, and points to link-in-bio. The enrolment window stays open through the waitlist period while anticipation content compounds; the 48-hour urgency window before close is the conversion engine — the two largest sales days — supported by last-chance content and a final email push. The email sequence runs announcement → reminder → urgency → last-chance, mirroring the on-platform content so the warm list converts at its highest possible rate right before the doors lock.

10. Community & Retention Strategy

The Discord community is the one component that appreciates with every new member while everything else merely holds its value — which makes it the only true moat in the business.

Why community is the most important asset

A PDF is worth the same to the thousandth buyer as to the first. A community is worth dramatically more to the thousandth buyer, because its value is a function of how many other people are inside it. This is the only component with that property, so it is the only component that constitutes a true moat. Competitors can clone the deliverable instantly; they cannot clone a living room of hundreds mid-cohort, the proof on the walls, or the friendships forming in general chat. The community is simultaneously the product's stickiness mechanism, its best marketing channel, and its competitive defence.

The one-time-use gating system

Access is gated by a single-use alphanumeric code delivered in the PDF and confirmation email, redeemed once through a free verification bot that grants the member role and then expires the code so it cannot be shared. Technically this enforces paid-only access with no custom infrastructure; experientially, entering a code that works once makes membership feel earned and exclusive, raising perceived value the moment a member walks in.

Moderators, roles & the collector mechanic

The founder moderates personally at launch — ~15 minutes a day to read check-ins, respond, and keep energy high, which also keeps the founder close to the customer. Past 500 members, the most engaged member is promoted to moderator in exchange for free future access — a proven model where a community's most passionate member becomes its manager at near-zero cash cost, recruited from within so culture is preserved. Roles and badges progress with participation, and badges are collectible across challenge volumes — a retention and cross-sell engine, because a member buys the next challenge partly to complete the set. Recognition, not cash, is the currency, which keeps the honor-based system cheap and the motivation intrinsic.

The network-effect flywheel. Each new member posts check-ins and before/after content → the day-channels fill and the community feels more alive → the experience becomes more valuable and motivating for every existing member → completion rates rise → more proof content is produced → which markets the next cohort and feeds the affiliate engine → which brings in more members. Every turn makes the platform more valuable for everyone already on it and harder for any competitor to displace. This is the structural reason the business compounds rather than merely repeats.

From community to platform

The terminal state is the platform transition: once the community is large, active and culturally established, outside creators host their own challenges inside it for a revenue share. The community built in Year One to retain members becomes, in the maturity phase, the asset that attracts creators and justifies a venture-scale outcome — the network effect that began with synchronised cohorts becoming a two-sided marketplace.

11. Financial Model

A live month-by-month Year-1 P&L and a 3-year projection — every cell driven by the panel. Figures are deliberately conservative and consistent with the unit economics in Section 7.

\$33.2K

Year 1 revenue

\$17.8K

Year 1 EBITDA

54%

EBITDA margin

1,337

Challenge buyers (Y1)

154

Exit subscribers (M12)

\$1.4K

Exit MRR (membership)

\$17,779

Year-end cash (EBITDA cum.)

STATED ASSUMPTIONS

Four cohorts (Jan/Apr/Jul/Oct) with the size and growth set in the panel; Phone Detox launches in months 6 and 9; membership accumulates new subscribers from each cohort at the set conversion and erodes at the set monthly churn; expansion packs attach to new buyers; variable costs are platform fees plus affiliate commission on one-time sales; COGS $\approx$ 0; founder compensation is not drawn in Year 1.

Month	Buyers	Revenue	Variable	Fixed OpEx	EBITDA	Cum.
Jan ★	125	\$2,565	\$405	\$900	\$1,260	\$1,260
Feb	0	\$167	\$12	\$900	(\$744)	\$516
Mar	0	\$156	\$11	\$900	(\$755)	(\$239)
Apr ★	194	\$4,126	\$638	\$900	\$2,588	\$2,349
May	0	\$394	\$28	\$900	(\$533)	\$1,815
Jun ·	125	\$2,182	\$303	\$900	\$979	\$2,795
Jul ★	301	\$6,685	\$1,010	\$900	\$4,775	\$7,570
Aug	0	\$876	\$61	\$900	(\$85)	\$7,485
Sep ·	125	\$2,630	\$334	\$900	\$1,396	\$8,880
Oct ★	467	\$10,508	\$1,576	\$900	\$8,032	\$16,912
Nov	0	\$1,486	\$104	\$900	\$482	\$17,394
Dec	0	\$1,382	\$97	\$900	\$385	\$17,779
Year 1	1,337	\$33,156	\$4,578	\$10,800	\$17,779	\$17,779

Three-year projection

Year	Revenue	Gross profit	EBITDA	Margin
Year 1	\$33,156	\$30,835	\$17,779	54%
Year 2	\$76,260	\$70,922	\$36,605	48%
Year 3	\$152,519	\$141,843	\$73,209	48%

Sensitivity

The key variable in every scenario is the cohort-volume ramp (driven by content virality and creator performance); membership conversion is the secondary lever. The live scenario tag in the panel flips between **Conservative** (<\$55K), **Base** (\$55–110K) and **Optimistic** (>\$110K) as the total crosses those thresholds. Across all three, gross margin stays above 90% and the business is cash-flow positive from its first cohort — the downside is bounded by the near-zero cost structure, and the upside is driven by content outcomes the go-to-market engine is specifically designed to manufacture.

Snapshot — Glow Up \$18, Detox \$12, fee 7.0000000000000001%, affiliate 10%. Cohort 1 = 125 buyers, growth 55.000000000000001%/cohort (125→194→301→467). Membership \$9/mo, conversion 16%, churn 7.0000000000000001%/mo. Packs 12% @ \$9. Marketing \$600/mo, fixed OpEx \$300/mo.

12. Founding Team

The combination on display — technical ability to own the experience layer, quantitative rigour to exploit the data layer, and a real entrepreneurial track record — is rare in a first-time consumer-brand founder and directly de-risks the two hardest parts of this plan.

A founder built for this specific business

The Glow Room's central bet is that owning a branded, data-generating web app beats renting Notion — and that bet is only available to a founder who can actually build and operate software. Most consumer-brand founders cannot, which is exactly why most challenge products default to Notion and surrender their brand and data. This founder can, converting the single hardest and most defensible part of the plan from a hiring risk into an in-house capability. The match between founder and venture is not incidental; the entire architecture was chosen *because* the founder can execute it.

Web apps

Direct development experience — builds the owned app in-house

MSDAS

Data Analytics & Statistics, Washington University in St. Louis

2 ventures

UTrucking & Maison Lumière — real customers, real P&L

Technical & analytical foundation

Direct **web application development** experience is the linchpin of the technology strategy: the custom app and its behavioral-data pipeline can be built and iterated in-house on the Section-5 timeline without the cost, delay or loss of control of an external hire, and it makes the long-term platform vision a credible internal roadmap. The **quantitative analytics** foundation — anchored by graduate study in the MSDAS program at Washington University in St. Louis — is the second asset: the business's defensibility rests on the behavioral dataset the app generates, and a founder trained in data analytics and statistics can convert that raw data into better-designed cohorts, sharper Day-8 interventions, and disciplined, evidence-based decisions on pricing, content and paid amplification. The data moat is only a moat if someone can read it.

Entrepreneurial track record

The founder is not a first-time operator. Prior ventures — **UTrucking** and **Maison Lumière** — demonstrate the ability to start, build and run real businesses with real customers and real P&L responsibility, spanning operational logistics on one hand and brand/consumer sensibility on the other. The Glow Room requires both: operational discipline (a four-cohort-a-year machine, a moderated community, shipping software) and brand instinct (a Gen Z aesthetic and a warm, never-preachy voice). Having already built businesses on both sides of that line is precisely the experience this venture demands — and structurally avoids the three classic failure modes of a challenge-product founder (can't build, can't read data, never shipped).

13. Risks & Mitigations

Specific risks to this business — not generic startup risks — each paired with a mitigation, most already designed into the model.

Risk	Why it's real here	Mitigation
TikTok algorithm dependency	GTM leans on organic reach; an algo change or account loss throttles the primary channel	Own the email list from first touch; three content layers; affiliate spread; recurring membership revenue independent of new reach
Cohort dropout	Quitting dries up proof, repurchase and community energy	Designed emotional arc; fortified Day-8; synchronised cohort as social glue; habit anchor; data-driven re-engineering each cohort
Discord health	A community can turn toxic or silent — destroying the core asset	Founder-led moderation + clear rules at launch; moderators promoted from within; cohort cadence keeps energy refreshed
App failure mid-cohort	An outage during the check-in window damages brand at the worst moment	Managed serverless stack; Discord as functional fallback; in-house technical fixes; mandatory pre-cohort end-to-end testing
Creator underperformance	Seeded creators may post little or not convert	Over-provision (8–12, zero-COGS); founder journey as guaranteed baseline; self-replenishing community proof
Pricing sensitivity	\$18 may be too high to convert or too low to signal quality	Deliberate impulse/credibility balance; \$12 Detox entry; empirical price testing via data; \$25 premium tier
Funded competitor	Headspace/Noom could copy the format with more capital	Moat is community + proof + data + Gen-Z brand, not the format; incumbents structurally mismatched to TikTok-native, founder-led execution
Platform fee changes	Gumroad/Stripe/TikTok could raise fees	>90% margins absorb increases; multi-processor architecture; shift toward owned Stripe + membership
Key-person dependency	One founder builds, moderates and creates content	Delegated moderation as it scales; managed stack lowers bus-factor; recurring revenue persists through short absences; raise funds first hires
Seasonality	Revenue concentrated in four spikes; January outsized	Membership smooths troughs; packs sell year-round; Detox sequenced between cohorts; no single launch is the whole year
Privacy / minors	Audience includes 16-year-olds; app collects photos & behavioral data	Private per-user storage (RLS); public sharing only with explicit consent; minimal data collection; clear terms and age floor

14. 90-Day Launch Roadmap

Twelve weekly milestone sets with named deliverables, built around a flagship cohort Day 1 at roughly Day 90.

Week	Focus	Named deliverable
1	Brand + PDF	Locked name, visual identity, finished high-res Glow Up PDF
2	App foundation + core loop	Next.js + Supabase, magic-link auth, dashboard, check-ins, intake quiz — a member can complete a day
3	App engagement + Discord	Streaks, progress, leaderboard, push, Day-8 state; full server with code-gated bot
4	Commerce + test	Stripe + webhook provisioning, access codes, email wiring; full test purchase; sales page
5	Build in public	Live TikTok account + growing waitlist
6	Creator outreach	12 micro-influencers DM'd, access sent to every reply
7	Open enrolment	Announcement video live; cohort open; first sales; announcement email
8	Anticipation + proof	Daily content; first seeded-creator posts populate the sales-page testimonials
9	Urgency + close	48-hour window; urgency/last-chance emails; enrolment locked
10	Cohort Day 1 + first 100	Founder Day-1 content; every member welcomed personally; tone set for 30 days
11	Mid-cohort + sub seeding	Day-8 support; membership seeded to engaged members; best check-ins reposted
12	Day 30 + membership + analysis	Before/after reveals collected; <i>Glow Room Monthly</i> launched; post-cohort data analysis & Cohort-2 plan

15. Appendix

Ready-to-use assets so the plan can be executed immediately — production-drafted and on-brand: direct, warm, slightly funny, never preachy.

Glow Up Challenge — Days 1–7 (as they appear in the app)

Day	Movement	Skin	Mindset prompt
Day 1	20-min walk, outside if you can	Cleanser only — wash properly, AM & PM	"Write the version of you you're hoping to meet in 30 days. Be specific."
Day 2	20 min — walk or a stretch flow	Cleanser AM/PM	"One small thing you did today your future self would be proud of?"
Day 3	Walk + 5 squats whenever you remember	Cleanser + night moisturiser	"Three things you've been avoiding — and one sentence on why."
Day 4	20 min that raises your heart rate	SPF day — why it matters, how much, every morning	"What would you do this week if you knew you couldn't fail?"
Day 5	20-min walk + podcast/playlist	Cleanse, moisturise, SPF	"One belief about yourself that's held you back — where's it from?"
Day 6	Circuit ×3: 10 squats, 10 push-ups, 20s plank	Cleanse, moisturise, SPF	"A moment this week you felt genuinely good — what caused it?"
Day 7	Dance day — 5 songs, move how you want	Routine + Day-7 progress photo (same light as Day 1)	"Reflect on week one. What surprised you about yourself?"

Each day also assigns the member's chosen **habit anchor** (set in the intake quiz), identical for all 30 days.

Phone Detox — Days 1–3

- **Day 1 — The reveal.** Screenshot & log your current daily screen-time average (your "before"). Set one rule for tomorrow: no phone for the first hour after waking. *You can't change what you won't look at.*
- **Day 2 — Reclaim the morning.** Hold the rule. Delete the single app you lose the most time to — reinstall on Day 8 if you still want it (you won't).
- **Day 3 — Make it boring.** Grayscale for the day; move your top three time-sink apps off the home screen. *Colour and convenience are the slot-machine — remove them and the pull quietly dies.*

Discord welcome message

Welcome to The Glow Room. 💜 You made it in — which means you're holding a one-time code and you're officially one of us. **1.** Drop your code into #verify to unlock everything. **2.** Say hi in #introductions — name, where you're from, what you want from these 30 days, and your Day 1 stats. **3.** Find your day — when you finish, post your check-in in that day's channel. Watching the room fill with people doing the exact same day as you is the whole magic. No pressure to be perfect. Just show up. We'll do the rest together.

Creator outreach DM & follow-ups

Initial DM: "hey [name] — I really love your [content type] stuff. I'm launching a 30-day Glow Up Challenge on [date] — four pillars (movement, skin, mindset, one daily habit), all inside a little app + a private community doing it together. I'd love to give you full free access, no strings and zero obligation to post. Want me to send it over?"

On reply: send PDF + app access + Discord code, "your start date is [date], I'm around for questions."

Day 8: "how's it going? day 8 is the one where everyone wants to quit — if you're feeling it, that's exactly on schedule 🥳 makes for great content either way."

After a good post: "this is incredible — ok if I reshare it on the [brand] page with credit?"

TikTok scripts (3 formats)

- **Founder journey (Day 8):** "Day 8 and I genuinely almost quit this morning. Here's the thing nobody tells you — day 8 is *designed* to feel like this. So I did the smallest version: a 20-minute walk instead of a workout. Don't quit on the hardest day. Quit on an easy one. (You won't.)"
- **Community proof:** "This is [name] on Day 1 vs Day 30. She washed her face properly, walked every day, journaled five minutes, and showed up when she didn't feel like it. That's the whole thing. Next cohort starts [date]."
- **Phone Detox irony:** "I built a 7-day phone detox and I'm advertising it on TikTok. I know. But here's my screen time before [number] and after [number]. The challenge isn't throwing your phone in a lake — it's getting your first hour back. Link's in bio, ironically."

Cohort enrolment email sequence

1. **Announcement** — "Doors are open. We start [date]." What it is, four pillars in three lines, start + close dates, one CTA.
2. **Reminder** — "A quick look inside before you decide." App + Discord peek, one proof clip, CTA.
3. **Urgency (48h)** — "Enrolment closes in 48 hours — then we lock the doors." Next chance is [next cohort]. CTA.
4. **Last chance** — "Last call — doors close tonight." One paragraph, one CTA, the next cohort date as the cost of waiting.

Brand name shortlist & palette

SPRUCE

CORAL

TEAL

HONEY

IVORY

The Glow Room (lead) — feels like a place you arrive at, not a product; maps to the community-as-destination strategy and the "Glow Legend" badge language. **Luminous** — premium, harder to claim as a handle. **The Reset** — captures the seasonal framing; risks being generic. **Glow Era** — very Gen Z, hashtag-native, trend-dependent. *Recommendation (flagged — the name was left open): lead with The Glow Room, using "Glow Up Challenge" as the flagship product beneath it.*

Recommended stack & monthly cost

Tool	Purpose	Monthly
Next.js + Tailwind	App framework + styling	\$0
Vercel	Hosting / deploy	\$0 → \$20
Supabase	Postgres, auth, storage	\$0 → \$25
Stripe / Gumroad	Payments	% per txn
Resend / Postmark	Email	\$0 → \$15
OneSignal · Discord · MEE6	Push + community	\$0
PostHog	Behavioral analytics	\$0 → usage
Canva Pro	PDF + brand assets	~\$13
Total	Effectively \$0 early → at scale	~\$50–150